

CORE PURE / VECTORS, MATRICES & LINEAR TRANSFORMATIONS

Shortest Distances

Questions by topic

8 questions · 95 marks

Questions

Question 1	14 marks	2
Question 2	17 marks	3
Question 3	8 marks	4
Question 4	7 marks	5
Question 5	17 marks	6
Question 6	9 marks	7
Question 7	14 marks	8
Question 8	9 marks	9

1. The plane Π has equation $3x + y + 2z = -4$. The point P has coordinates $(5, -5, 3)$.

(a) Calculate the shortest distance from P to Π . [2]

The line L has vector equation

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

(b) Verify that P lies on L . [2]

(c) Find the coordinates of the point where L meets Π . [3]

(d) Determine the acute angle between L and Π . [4]

(e) Use the results of parts (b), (c) and (d) to verify your answer to part (a). [3]

2. The points C and D have coordinates $(0, 0, 2)$ and $(3, 3, -1)$ respectively.

The planes P_1 and P_2 have equations $x + y + z = 3$ and $2x - y = 1$ respectively.

(a) Find the acute angle between the line CD and the plane P_1 . [4]

(b) Show that the line CD meets P_1 and P_2 in a common point, and find its coordinates. [5]

(c) (i) Find $(\mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j} + \mathbf{k}) \times (2\mathbf{i} - \mathbf{j})$. [1]

(ii) Hence find the acute angle between the planes P_1 and P_2 . [3]

(iii) Find the shortest distance between the point C and the line of intersection of the planes P_1 and P_2 . [4]

3. The plane Π has equation

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} + \mu \begin{pmatrix} 4 \\ -1 \\ -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

where λ and μ are scalar parameters.

(a) Show that vector $\mathbf{i} - 2\mathbf{j} + 3\mathbf{k}$ is perpendicular to Π . [2]

(b) Hence find a Cartesian equation of Π . [2]

The line ℓ has equation

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

where t is a scalar parameter.

The point A lies on ℓ . Given that the shortest distance between A and Π is $\frac{9}{\sqrt{14}}$

(c) determine the possible coordinates of A . [4]

4. The line ℓ_1 has vector equation

$$\mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$$

The line ℓ_2 is the line of intersection of the planes

$$x - y + z = 6$$

and

$$2x + y - z = 3$$

(i) Find the shortest distance between ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 . [5]

(ii) Find a Cartesian equation of the plane which contains ℓ_1 and is parallel to ℓ_2 . [2]

5. (a) Show that the three planes with equations

$$\begin{aligned}x + \lambda y + z &= 4 \\2x - y + 2z &= 3 \\2x + y - z &= 5\end{aligned}\tag{3}$$

where λ is a constant, meet at a unique point except for one value of λ , which is to be determined.

- (b) In the case $\lambda = 2$, use matrices to find the point of intersection P of the planes, showing your method clearly. [3]

The line ℓ has equation

$$\frac{x+1}{1} = \frac{y-1}{-1} = \frac{z}{1}$$

- (c) Find a vector equation of ℓ . [2]

- (d) Find the shortest distance between the point P and ℓ . [4]

- (e) (i) Show that ℓ is parallel to the plane $2x + y - z = 5$. [3]

- (ii) Find the distance between ℓ and the plane $2x + y - z = 5$. [2]

6. (a) The plane Π passes through the points $A(1, -2, 3)$, $B(2, 0, 3)$ and $C(2, -2, 2)$.

The point D has coordinates $(4, 1, 0)$. Find the shortest distance between D and Π .

[4]

- (b) Lines ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 have the following equations.

$$\ell_1 : \mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix} + \lambda \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\ell_2 : \mathbf{r} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} + \mu \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -2 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

Find, in exact form, the distance between ℓ_1 and ℓ_2 .

[5]

7. The position vectors of the points A , B , C , D are

$$\mathbf{i} + 2\mathbf{j}, \quad 2\mathbf{i} + 2\mathbf{j}, \quad \mathbf{i} + 3\mathbf{j} + 2\mathbf{k}, \quad 2\mathbf{i} + 3\mathbf{j} + m\mathbf{k}$$

respectively, where m is an integer.

It is given that the shortest distance between the line through A and D and the line through B and C is $\frac{1}{\sqrt{14}}$.

(a) Show that the only possible value of m is 1. [7]

(b) Find the shortest distance of C from the line through A and D . [3]

(c) Show that the acute angle between the planes ABD and ACD is $\cos^{-1}\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\right)$. [4]

8. (a) Given that $\mathbf{u} = \lambda\mathbf{i} - 2\mathbf{j} + 2\mathbf{k}$ and $\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j} - \mathbf{k}$, find the following, giving your answers in terms of λ .

(i) $\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}$ [1]

(ii) $\mathbf{u} \times \mathbf{v}$ [2]

(b) Hence determine

(i) the acute angle between the planes $2x - 2y + 2z = 11$ and $x + y - z = 7$ [3]

(ii) the shortest distance between the lines

$$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{i} - \mathbf{k} + s(\mathbf{i} - 2\mathbf{j} + 2\mathbf{k})$$

and

$$\mathbf{r} = 2\mathbf{i} + 3\mathbf{j} + 3\mathbf{k} + t(\mathbf{i} + \mathbf{j} - \mathbf{k})$$

giving your answer as a multiple of $\sqrt{2}$. [3]